

HOW ARE YOU FEELING?

It's ok to feel any of these emotions.

Name it. Accept it. Talk about it.

HAPPY



I feel happy when something good happens.

SAD



I feel sad when something hurts my feelings or I lose something.

ANGRY



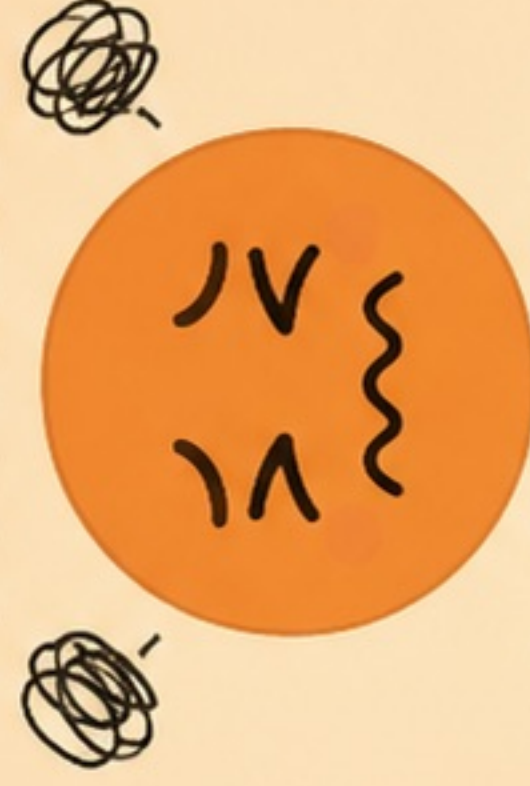
I feel angry when something isn't fair or I don't get my way.

SCARED



I feel scared when something feels dangerous or unfamiliar.

FRUSTRATED



I feel frustrated when something is hard or not going the way I want.

OVERWHELMED



I feel overwhelmed when there is too much happening or it's too much to handle.

CALM



I feel calm when I am relaxed, safe and everything feels okay.



All feelings are important. You are not alone. I am here for you.

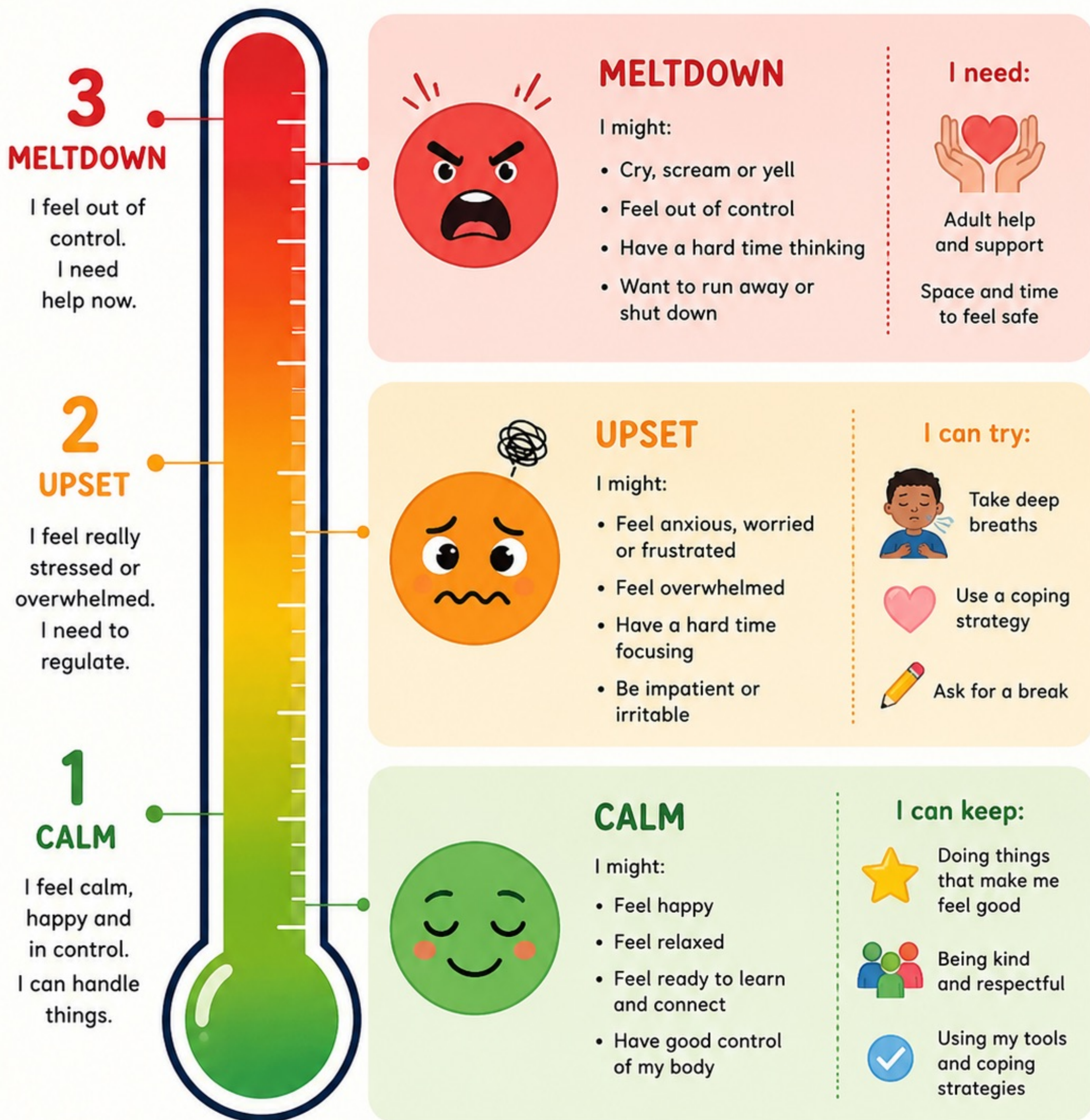


FEELINGS THERMOMETER

Everyone has feelings. It's okay!



The goal is to recognize how we feel and use tools to cope.



Feelings come and go.
I can ride the wave and get back to green.



WHAT TO DO WHEN I FEEL OVERWHELMED

Simple steps to help my body and mind feel calm again.

1



PAUSE

Stop. I can take a moment.



2



BREATHE

Take slow deep breaths
in and out.



3



GO TO MY SAFE SPACE

I can find a quiet,
calm place.



4



USE A CALMING TOOL

I can pick something
that helps me feel better.



5



ASK FOR HELP

I can tell a grown-up:
I need help or
I need a break.



6



COME BACK WHEN READY

When my body feels calm,
I can try again.



Big feelings are okay. I can take it one step at a time.



MY FEELINGS CHECK-IN

Take a moment to check in with yourself.

♥ Circle how you feel today. ♥

HAPPY



I feel happy
and good.

SAD



I feel sad
or down.

ANGRY



I feel angry
or mad.

SCARED



I feel scared
or afraid.

FRUSTRATED



I feel frustrated
or annoyed.

OVERWHELMED



I feel overwhelmed
or stressed.

CALM



I feel calm, relaxed
and in control.



★ What happened today? _____

♥ What do I need right now? _____

💡 What can help me feel better? _____

♥ All feelings are okay. Be kind to yourself. ♥



CALM DOWN CHOICE BOARD



Different things help us calm down.

Pick a strategy you can try!

TAKE DEEP BREATHS



Breathe in slowly through your nose. Breathe out slowly through your mouth.

COUNT TO 10



Count slowly to 10. You can go to 20 if you need to.

DRINK SOME WATER



Take a sip of water and give your body a break.

STRETCH



Stretch your body and let out any tension.

HUG SOMETHING SOFT



Hug a stuffed animal, pillow, or a soft blanket.

TAKE A BREAK



Step away from the situation and take some time for yourself.

DRAW OR COLOR



Color or draw something that helps you feel calm.

LISTEN TO MUSIC



Listen to your favorite calm or happy music.

THINK HAPPY THOUGHTS



Think of something that makes you happy and makes you smile.

SQUEEZE OR PUSH



Squeeze a stress ball or push against a wall for a few seconds.

GO OUTSIDE



Get some fresh air and move your body outside.

POSITIVE SELF-TALK



Remind yourself: I can do hard things. I am strong. I can try.



You know yourself best. Choose what helps **YOU** feel calm.
It's okay to try more than one!



BELLY BREATHING



A simple way to calm your body and mind.



Belly breathing helps you feel calm, relaxed and in control.
Let's try it together!



1

SIT COMFORTABLY



Sit or lie down.
Put one hand on
your belly and
one hand on
your chest.



2

BREATHE IN



Breathe in slowly
through your nose.
Feel your belly
get bigger.



3

BREATHE OUT



Breathe out slowly
through your mouth.
Feel your belly
get smaller.



4

REPEAT



Take slow, deep
breaths. You can
do this as many
times as you need.



≡ REMEMBER ≡

Slow breaths help you feel calm.
You can use belly breathing
anytime, anywhere!



I can pause. I can breathe.
I can handle this.



5-4-3-2-1 GROUNDING



A tool to help you feel calm and stay in the present.



Use your 5 senses to notice what is around you right now.



5
SEE

5 things
you can **see**.

Look around. What
do you notice?



Got it!

4
FEEL

4 things
you can **feel**.

Notice how things
feel around you.



Got it!

3
HEAR

3 things
you can **hear**.

Listen closely.
What do you hear?



Got it!

2
SMELL

2 things
you can **smell**.

Take a deep breath.
What can you smell?



Got it!

1
TASTE

1 thing
you can **taste**.

What can you taste
right now?



Got it!



You are here. You are safe.
Take a deep breath. You've got this!



MY CALM DOWN KIT LIST

These are the things that help ME feel calm.
I can use them when I feel upset, stressed or overwhelmed.



I know myself best. I will build a kit that works for ME!



WHAT HELPS ME CALM DOWN:



SOMETHING I CAN
LOOK AT

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING I CAN
TOUCH OR SQUEEZE

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING I CAN
HEAR

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING I CAN
SMELL

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING I CAN
TASTE

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING THAT
HELPS MY BODY

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING THAT
HELPS MY MIND

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING THAT
BRINGS ME COMFORT

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



SOMETHING ELSE
THAT HELPS ME

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



MY PROMISE TO MYSELF:

I will take care of myself.

I will use my calm down kit.

I am strong. I can handle this.



Name: _____

Date: _____



MY MORNING ROUTINE



♥ A good morning sets me up for a great day! ♥

1



Wake up
and smile!

☐

2



Make my bed.

☐

3



Brush my teeth
and wash my face.

☐

4



Get dressed.

☐

5



Eat a healthy
breakfast.

☐

6



Pack my bag
and check what
I need.

☐

7



Put on my shoes
and get ready.

☐

8



Take a deep breath
and have a great day! ♥

☐

MY BEDTIME ROUTINE

♥ A calm night helps me sleep tight and wake up bright! ♥

1



Clean up
my toys.

☐

2



Take a bath
or shower.

☐

3



Brush my teeth
and wash my face.

☐

4



Put on my
pajamas.

☐

5



Have a small snack
and a drink.

☐

6



Read a book
or quiet activity.

☐

7



Say goodnight
and take deep breaths.

☐

8



Time for bed.
Sleep tight! ♥

☐

I am proud of myself for taking care of me!





MY SCHOOL DAY SCHEDULE



Knowing my plan helps me have a great day! 



Name: _____

Date: _____

TIME	ACTIVITY	NOTES / REMINDERS
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		
 ____:____		



I can follow my schedule.
I can do hard things! 





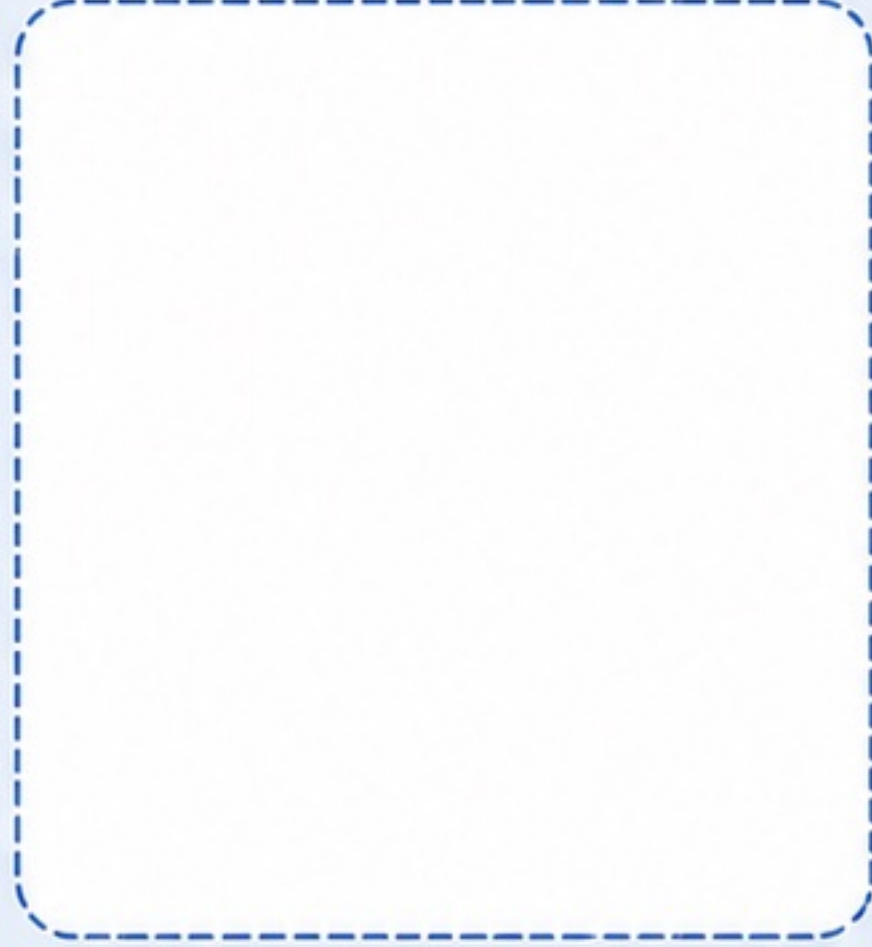
FIRST

/ THEN



First we do this, then we do that! 

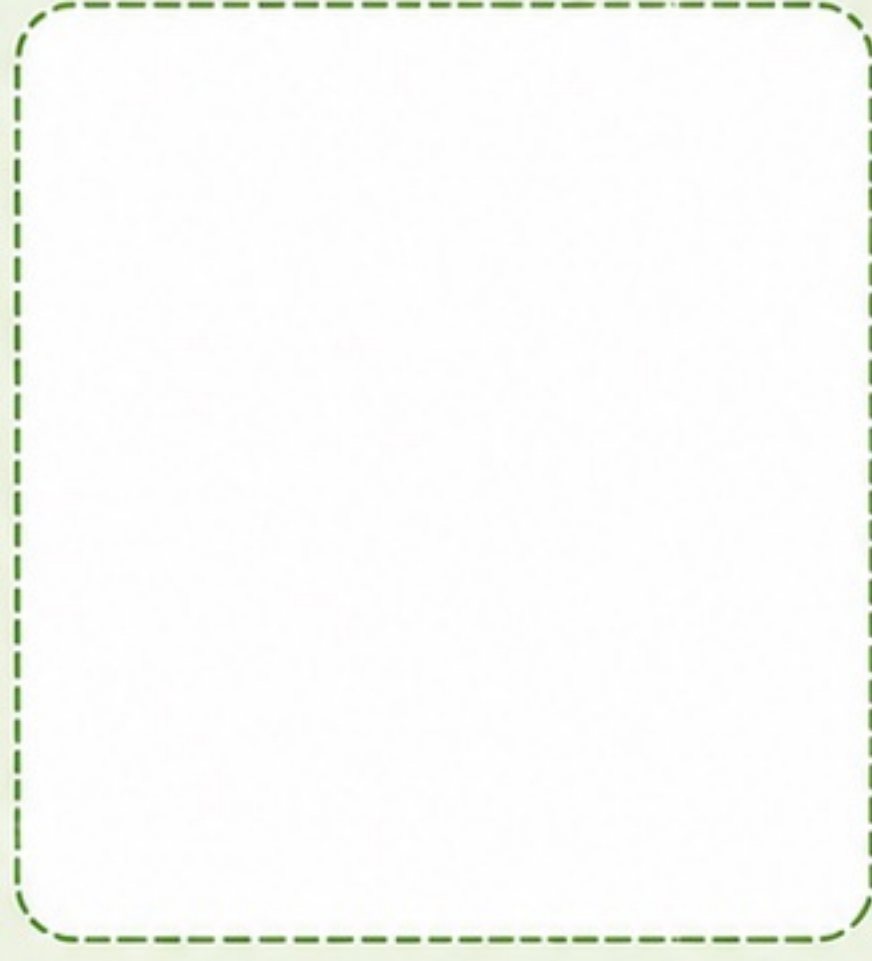
FIRST



We do this first.



THEN



Then we do this.

Examples:



Do my work



Read a book



Finish my work



Tablet time



Play time



Break time



I can do hard things! 



YES

NO

It's ok to make a choice!

YES

I want to...



This means:

I agree.

I choose yes.



NO

I don't want to...



This means:

I don't agree.

I choose no.



My choice is important. I can use my words.



I NEED A BREAK



I am feeling overwhelmed,
frustrated, or need a
moment to reset.

I can come back
when I am ready. ♥

A BREAK MIGHT LOOK LIKE:



Quiet
space



Headphones



Deep
breaths



A few
minutes



Thank you for helping me take a break.
It helps me feel better so I can learn and do my best.





HOW MY BODY FEELS



Different feelings show up in my body. I can listen to my body!

FEELING	WHAT I MIGHT NOTICE IN MY BODY	WHAT CAN HELP
 ANGRY	 • My fists clench. • My jaw feels tight. • My heart beats fast. • My body feels hot. • I want to yell or hit.	    • Take deep breaths • Squeeze a stress ball • Count to 10 • Take a break
 WORRIED	 • My stomach feels funny. • My heart beats fast. • My muscles feel tense. • I feel shaky or restless. • I have lots of "what if" thoughts.	    • Take slow, deep breaths • Talk to someone • Write or draw • Use a fidget or take a break
 SAD	 • My chest feels heavy. • My energy is low. • I feel like crying. • I want to be alone. • My shoulders slouch.	    • Talk about how I feel • Listen to music • Hug something soft • Do something I enjoy
 HAPPY	 • My face smiles. • My body feels relaxed. • I have more energy. • My heart feels light. • I feel calm and good.	    • Keep doing what helps • Share my joy • Be kind • Enjoy the moment
 SCARED	 • My heart beats fast. • I feel shaky. • My stomach hurts. • My eyes get wide. • I want to run or hide.	    • Ground myself (5-4-3-2-1) • Take deep breaths • Stay with someone I trust • Remind myself I am safe



My body gives me clues. I can listen, take care of myself, and ask for help.





MY TRIGGERS



Understanding my triggers helps me feel safe, supported, and successful. 

FOR PARENTS / CAREGIVERS: Use this worksheet to help identify what may trigger big emotions, challenging behaviors, or shutdowns for your child. Share with teachers, therapists, and other supportive adults.

Child's Name: _____

Date: _____

Completed by: _____

Relationship to Child: _____



WHEN

When / at what times does this happen?



WHERE

Where does this usually happen?



WHAT

What happens right before?
(What is the trigger?)



HOW IT LOOKS

What does it look like when my child is triggered?



HOW IT AFFECTS THEM

How does it affect my child?



WHAT MIGHT MY CHILD BE THINKING OR FEELING?

What thoughts, worries, or feelings might be underneath the behavior?



WHAT HELPS?

What helps my child feel better or regulate after being triggered?



WHAT CAN WE DO TO PREVENT OR REDUCE TRIGGERS?

What can we do to support my child, avoid or reduce triggers, or set them up for success?



ADDITIONAL NOTES / IMPORTANT DETAILS

Anything else helpful for others to know?



Thank you for helping my team understand how to best support me!





MELTDOWN RECOVERY STEPS



For after a hard moment 



Meltdowns are hard. Recovery takes time.
These steps can help me feel safe, calm, and ready again.



1



I need space. 

It's okay to take space.
I can go to my safe
space or quiet area.

- ♥ I can be alone
for a little while.
- ♥ I don't have to
talk right now.

2



I breathe. 

I can take deep breaths
to help my body calm
down.

- Breathe in slowly
- Breathe out slowly
- Repeat a few times

3



I take care of
my body. 

I can give my body what
it needs.

- Drink some water
- Eat a snack
- Use the bathroom
- Stretch or move

4



I soothe myself. 

I can do things that
help me feel calm.

- Use something comforting
- Listen to music
- Draw or color
- Fidget or squeeze something

5



I think about it. 

When I feel better, I can
think about what happened.

- What triggered me?
- What can I do
differently next time?
- What do I need?

6



I'm ready to try again. 

I can return when I feel
calm and ready.

- I can ask for help
- I can take small steps
- I can keep practicing



I am doing my best. I am learning and growing.
I am not alone. 





SAFE SPACE SETUP CHECKLIST



A calm, comfortable space can help my child feel safe, regulated, and ready to handle big feelings.



Safe Space Location: _____

Date Set Up / Reviewed: _____



COMFORT

Cozy and calming things that help my child feel safe.

- ☐ Comfortable seating (bean bag, cushion, floor pillow, chair)
- ☐ Soft blanket or throw
- ☐ Calming colors / low lighting
- ☐ Quiet and away from high-traffic areas
- ☐ Good temperature



TOOLS & RESOURCES

Helpful tools to support regulation and coping.

- ☐ Fidget tools (fidgets, stress ball, pop it)
- ☐ Calming tools (sensory items, squishy, texture items)
- ☐ Breathing or grounding tools (pinwheel, breathing cards, timers)
- ☐ Visuals or feeling charts
- ☐ Books or social stories
- ☐ Noise-canceling headphones (if helpful)



SENSORY CONSIDERATIONS

Reduce overwhelm and support sensory needs.

- ☐ Minimize loud noises and distractions
- ☐ Adjust lighting (soft, natural, or dim)
- ☐ Consider smells (neutral or calming)
- ☐ Include items that support sensory needs
- ☐ Allow movement if helpful (wobble cushion, resistance band, etc.)



PERSONALIZATION

Make it a space that feels welcoming and meaningful.

- ☐ Include my child's favorite items
- ☐ Decorate with things that bring comfort or joy
- ☐ Involve my child in creating the space
- ☐ Add positive reminders or affirmations ("I am safe", "I can handle hard things")



ROUTINE & USE

Help my child know when and how to use their safe space.

- ☐ Explain the purpose of the safe space
- ☐ Create a plan for when to use it
- ☐ Practice using the space when calm
- ☐ Respect my child's need for space
- ☐ Check in and adjust as needed

My Plan

1. I feel my body getting upset.
2. I take a break in my safe space.
3. I use tools that help me.
4. I feel calm and ready.



NOTES / WHAT WORKS WELL:



MAINTENANCE CHECK:

- ☐ Check items regularly
- ☐ Replace or refresh as needed
- ☐ Ask my child what else would help them feel safe



A safe space is not a punishment. It is a tool for regulation, connection, and building skills that last a lifetime.





CAREGIVER SELF-CARE CHECKLIST



Taking care of me helps me show up for others.



You can't pour from an empty cup. Regular self-care helps you stay strong, calm, and better equipped to care for your child.

Date: _____

TODAY I WILL:

Be kind to myself
Do what I can
Celebrate small wins



PHYSICAL

Take care of my body.

- ☐ I drank water today
- ☐ I ate nourishing food
- ☐ I got some movement or exercise
- ☐ I got enough sleep (or rested)
- ☐ I took time to relax my body

IDEAS:

- Take a walk
- Stretch
- Drink a glass of water
- Take a warm shower
- Get enough rest



EMOTIONAL

Check in with my feelings.

- ☐ I noticed how I'm feeling
- ☐ I gave myself permission to feel
- ☐ I talked to someone I trust
- ☐ I set a healthy boundary
- ☐ I practiced self-compassion

IDEAS:

- Journal
- Talk to a friend
- Say kind things to myself
- Take deep breaths
- Ask for help



MENTAL

Give my mind a break.

- ☐ I took breaks today
- ☐ I did something I enjoy
- ☐ I unplugged or limited screen time
- ☐ I learned something new
- ☐ I let go of what I can't control

IDEAS:

- Read a book
- Listen to music or a podcast
- Do a puzzle or hobby
- Spend time in nature
- Practice mindfulness



SOCIAL

Connect with others.

- ☐ I spent time with people who lift me up
- ☐ I reached out or stayed connected
- ☐ I accepted support when offered
- ☐ I spent quality time with loved ones
- ☐ I didn't isolate myself

IDEAS:

- Call a friend
- Join a support group
- Plan a coffee date
- Spend time with family
- Laugh together



SPIRITUAL/ PURPOSE

Reconnect with what matters.

- ☐ I took time for gratitude
- ☐ I reflected on what brings me joy
- ☐ I did something that feels meaningful
- ☐ I connected with my values
- ☐ I felt a sense of purpose today

IDEAS:

- Pray or meditate
- Write in a gratitude list
- Volunteer
- Spend time in nature
- Do something that fills your cup



TODAY I'M PROUD OF:



I'M GRATEFUL FOR:



REMEMBER:

Small steps count. You matter. You are enough. Thank you for all you do.





EMERGENCY CALM PLAN



A plan to help my child feel safe, calm, and supported during a crisis.

Child's Name: _____

Date: _____

Completed By: _____

Relationship to Child: _____

1 WHEN MY CHILD IS BECOMING OVERWHELMED, IT MIGHT LOOK LIKE:

(Early signs)



- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

2 WHAT ARE MY CHILD'S TRIGGERS?

(Situations, events, environments, etc.)



- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

3 WHAT HELPS MY CHILD CALM DOWN?

(Use what works—every child is different)



BREATHE



SENSORY



COMFORT



ACTIVITY /
MOVEMENT



OTHER

- | | | | | |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ | ☐ _____ |
| Other: _____ | Other: _____ | Other: _____ | Other: _____ | Other: _____ |

★ These calm strategies work best (top 3): 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

4 WHAT CAREGIVERS CAN DO THAT HELPS:

(What I need you to do / say / avoid)



PLEASE DO:

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

PLEASE AVOID:

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Helpful things to say: _____

5 IF MY CHILD NEEDS SPACE:

(What helps them feel safe)



Best calm-down space: _____
Who should give space: _____
How much space/time helps: _____
How I will know they need space: _____

6 WHEN MY CHILD IS CALM AGAIN:

(How we reconnect and move forward)



How I will know they are ready: _____
What helps them reconnect: _____
What we can do together: _____
Who to talk to if more support is needed: _____

7 EMERGENCY CONTACTS & SUPPORTS



Name: _____	Phone: _____	Relationship: _____
Name: _____	Phone: _____	Relationship: _____
Name: _____	Phone: _____	Relationship: _____

♥ This plan is a guide. I will be patient and flexible. We will get through this together. ♥